

Sony's Shohei Toyoda on changing trends in the audio industry, Sony's in-house custom audio chips, and more

We sat down with **Mr Shohei Toyoda** to understand the changes in the audio industry and get insights about Sony's innovations

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The audio industry is growing at an exponential rate year after year with new trends emerging that benefit consumers. The industry has also seen a shift in trends as we emerge from the work-from-home norm as people across industries begin going back to offices for work. Features such as Active Noise Cancellation, Transparency/Ambient Mode, Low-Latency Mode, and others are increasingly sought after by individuals irrespective of price. We've seen TWS as low as ₹2,000 come packing ANC abilities while over-ear headphones priced at ₹7-10K are being shipped with this once-elusive feature as well. We recently tested the Sony WH-CH720N (review) which is a great example of this changing trend. To that end, we spoke to Shohei Toyoda, Head of Audio Business at Sony India to understand changing audio trends in 2023, gain an insight into Sony's lauded in-house ANC chipsets, and get a glimpse of what Sony's R&D industry may be working on in the near future.

🗣️ **The past three years have been challenging for those in the space**



Shohei Toyoda
Head of Audio Business,
Sony India

of consumer electronics. With trends changing yet again this year, with individuals going back to work, how is Sony adapting to the change in trends?

🔵 At Sony, we are keeping a close watch on the market trends and the ever-evolving requirements of our customers. We have observed a shift in customer purchase behaviour towards premium segment headphones with a particular emphasis on advanced features such as top-notch noise cancellation, exceptional audio quality, feather-light weight, prolonged battery

life and seamless connectivity across multiple devices.

We have recently launched two new headphones that cater to modern-day consumer demands. The WH-CH720N noise-cancelling headphones and WH-CH520 headphones are designed for prolonged usage, delivering a remarkable battery life of 50 hours. These headphones provide an immersive audio experience while ensuring ultimate comfort for extended periods of time.

🗣️ **Can you give us some insight into Sony's in-house custom chips used in Audio products and how they improve the quality of your headphones?**

🔵 Sony has been working on technology to give the best-in-class experience to customers. Our Dual Noise Sensor technology captures ambient noise and passes the data to the trusted HD Noise Cancelling Processor QN1. Then a new BLUETOOTH Audio SoC (System on Chip) senses and adjusts to music and noise at over 700 times per second. Using a new algorithm, the HD Noise Cancelling Processor QN1 applies noise cancelling processing in real time. This allows the user to focus more on the music they love and blur out the chaos of the outside world.

🗣️ **The audience for soundbars has been growing in India. How is Sony doing in this space and what has the revenue been like? How much do soundbars as a category**